CHEVENING SCHOLARSHIP 2027-28

A practical preparation guide for Indian applicants

APPLICATIONS ARE OPEN NOW

DEADLINE
6 October 2026
11:00 UTC · 4:30 PM IST

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Inside this guide

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Important: Chevening states that using AI software to generate application answers is strictly prohibited. Use this guide to plan and organise your evidence, but write your application in your own words.

Prepared by 1% Abroad · Strategy-first study abroad mentorship

1. First, check whether you are eligible

For the current Chevening Scholarship cycle, the core eligibility requirements include:

✓	**Citizenship**	Be a citizen of a Chevening-eligible country or territory. India is included in the current scholarship cycle.
✓	**Return commitment**	Commit to returning to your country of award for at least 2 years after the scholarship ends.
✓	**Work experience**	Have at least 2,800 hours of work experience gained after completing your undergraduate degree, over a minimum of 2 years.
✓	**Degree timing**	For the 2027-28 cycle, your undergraduate degree must have been completed by October 2024.
✓	**Academic eligibility**	Hold an undergraduate degree that qualifies you for entry to a UK master's programme.
✓	**UK government funding**	You must not have previously studied in the UK with a UK Government-funded scholarship.

What does Chevening normally cover?

- Tuition fees (subject to programme rules; MBA programmes have a fee cap).
- Economy travel to and from your country of residence by an approved route.
- Visa application cost for the scholar.
- Arrival and departure allowances.
- Monthly living allowance (stipend), with rates differing inside/outside London.
- A contribution toward TB testing where required, plus applicable travel support for Chevening events.

Do not confuse “fully funded” with “every possible personal expense is covered.” Always read the final award terms for your specific scholarship.

2. Chevening 2027-28 timeline

These are the official dates published for the current Chevening Scholarship cycle.

4 Aug 2026	**Applications opened** 11:00 UTC
6 Oct 2026	**Applications close** 11:00 UTC · 4:30 PM IST
Oct 2026	**Eligibility sifting begins**
Mid-Oct 2026 - Jan 2027	**Independent reading committee assessments**
Mid-Feb 2027	**Interview shortlist announced**
Mar - Apr 2027	**Interviews** British embassies / high commissions
Mid-Jun 2027	**Results announced**
8 Jul 2027	**Unconditional university offer deadline** 17:00 BST
Sep / Oct 2027	**Studies begin in the UK**

For viewers seeing this PDF now: the scholarship application closes in a few days. Submit early enough to review your work and avoid last-minute portal issues.

3. What you should prepare before you submit

Chevening is not just an academic scholarship. The application tests your evidence of leadership, relationship-building, course fit, and future impact.

Your strongest leadership examples	Choose real situations where you took ownership, influenced others, solved a problem, or created measurable impact. Focus on what you did and what changed.
Relationship-building / networking examples	Prepare examples showing how you built and maintained professional relationships and used them to achieve a positive outcome.
A clear course rationale	Research your first-choice course deeply: modules, skills, academic fit, and how it connects to your background and goals. You still list three eligible course choices.
A short-, mid- and long-term career plan	Your goals should be specific, realistic, measurable, and connected to positive change in your home country.
A clean work-history record	List dates, weekly hours, job titles, responsibilities and employment periods accurately. The system calculates your total work-experience hours.
Two referees	Prepare the names and contact details of two suitable referees. They may be professional, academic, or one of each; they cannot be a friend or relative.

The four application essay areas

Leadership & influence · Relationship-building · Course choices · Future career goals

Write your answers in English, respect the word limits in the portal, and prepare them separately before pasting them into the application system. Chevening explicitly requires original writing and prohibits AI-generated application answers.

4. Course choices, university applications & documents

Your Chevening application and your UK university applications are separate processes.

Your three course choices must be:

- Full-time and based in the UK.
- A taught master's degree (not a research-focused MRes).
- Starting in the autumn term, usually September/October.
- Between 9 and 12 months in duration.
- Not part-time, distance learning, PhD/DPhil, or a course with more than one month of study outside the UK.

University offer rule

You do not need an unconditional offer when you first submit the Chevening application. However, if you are successful at interview, you must submit at least one unconditional offer from one of your listed eligible courses by **8 July 2027, 17:00 BST**.

Documents to plan for

At application stage	Personal details, education history, work history, three course choices, details of two referees, and the four essay responses.
If shortlisted for interview	Photo ID, official undergraduate degree certificate/diploma, and two reference letters. Chevening states these documents must be uploaded at least seven working days before the interview.
Reference letters	Must be written in English, or accompanied by the original plus a notarised English translation. Chevening does not contact your referees for you.

Good preparation move: apply to your university courses soon after submitting Chevening. University deadlines and processing times are separate from the scholarship deadline.

5. Common mistakes that can weaken or invalidate an application

1. Not meeting 2,800 hours

Work experience must be gained after undergraduate completion and accumulated over at least two years.

2. Entering work history inaccurately

Avoid duplicate periods, unrealistic weekly hours, or incorrect dates.

3. Choosing ineligible courses

Check that all three choices meet Chevening course rules.

4. Generic leadership claims

Use specific examples with your action, influence and result - not only job titles or responsibilities.

5. Weak course connection

Show why the course fits your background and future plan, especially your first choice.

6. Vague career goals

Use concrete short-, mid- and long-term goals instead of broad ambitions.

7. Leaving referees too late

Choose people who know your work and can comment credibly on your leadership, relationships and ability to complete demanding study.

8. Using AI-generated essay answers

Chevening states this is strictly prohibited.

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Your final 5-day checklist

- ■ Confirm eligibility and work-experience hours.
- ■ Lock your three eligible UK master's choices.
- ■ Refine all four essay answers in your own words.
- ■ Check every date, employer, weekly-hour entry and qualification detail.
- ■ Confirm both referees' names, job details and contact information.
- ■ Submit before 6 October 2026, 11:00 UTC (4:30 PM IST) - not at the last minute.

6. Official sources used for this guide

This PDF was prepared using official Chevening guidance and checked on 1 October 2026. Scholarship rules can change, so the official Chevening website should always be your final authority.

Application timeline	chevening.org/scholarships/application-timeline/
Chevening in India	chevening.org/scholarship/india/
Prepare your application	chevening.org/resource-hub/guidance/prepare-your-application/
Application criteria	chevening.org/resource-hub/guidance/application-criteria/
How to apply / online system	chevening.org/resource-hub/guidance/online-application-system/
Work experience	chevening.org/scholarships/who-can-apply/work-experience/
Course eligibility	chevening.org/scholarships/guidance/courses/
References	chevening.org/resource-hub/guidance/references/
What the scholarship covers	chevening.org/faqs/what-does-a-chevening-scholarship-cover/

Want help building a stronger study-abroad strategy?
1% Abroad focuses on course fit, profile positioning, application strategy and long-term outcomes.

DM 1% Abroad to start with a profile review.

Disclaimer: This is an informational guide, not an official Chevening publication. Always verify your final application against the current Chevening website and your country/territory page.